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**Subject: English1**

# Unit 11: Five Basic Parts of an Organization

**UNIT FOCUS:**

- **Reading:** Five Basic Parts of an Organization.
- **Vocabulary:** Pairs, Synonyms.
- **Grammar:** Relative Clauses.

**"Structure is not an end in itself, but a means to an end—the end of organizational effectiveness."**
**(Henry Mintzberg)**

## Reading

Read the Text. Underline the New Words.

Organizations can be described in terms of their use of the **coordinating mechanisms [1]**. In theory, the simplest organization can rely on **mutual adjustment [2]** to coordinate its **basic work [4]** of producing a product or service. Its **operators [3]** - those who do this basic work - are largely **self-sufficient [29]**. As the organization grows, however, and adopts a more complex **division of labor [5]** among its operators, the need is increasingly felt for **direct supervision [6]**. So, whereas the division of labor up to this point has been between the operators themselves, the introduction of a manager introduces a first **administrative division of labor [30]** in the structure - between those who do the work and those who supervise it. And as the organization further elaborates itself, more managers are added - not only managers of operators but also managers of managers. An **administrative hierarchy [7]** of authority is built.

As the process of elaboration continues, the organization turns increasingly to **standardization [8]** as a means of coordinating the work of its operators. The responsibility for much of this standardization falls on a third group, composed of **analysts [9]**. Some, such as **work study analysts [10]** and **industrial engineers [25]**, concern themselves with the **standardization of work processes [11]**; others, such as **quality control engineers [26]**, accountants, planners, and **production schedulers [28]**, focus on the **standardization of outputs [12]**; while a few, such as **personnel trainers [27]**, are charged with the **standardization of skills [13]** (although most of this standardization takes place outside the organization, before the operators are hired). The introduction of these analysts brings a second kind of administrative division of labor to the organization, between those who do and who supervise the work, and those who standardize it. Whereas in the first case managers assumed responsibility from the operators for some of the

coordination of their work by substituting direct supervision for mutual adjustment, the analysts assume responsibility from the managers (and the operators) by substituting standardization for direct supervision (and mutual adjustment). Earlier, some of the control over the work was removed from the operator; now it begins to be removed from the manager as well as the systems designed by the analysts take increasing responsibility for coordination.

Managers can be divided into two groups. Those at the very top of the hierarchy, together with their own personal staff, form the **strategic apex [14]**. And those below, who join the strategic apex to the **operating core [15]** through the **chain of command [17]**, make up the **middle line [16]**.

The bricks of all organizations are its employees, so how their jobs are designed and how they adjust to the organization has a high impact on the entire organization. The first of the three parameters in this category is **job specialization [18]**, and can be done in two dimensions. **Horizontal job specialization [19]** is the most dominant form as it defines the breadth of tasks assigned to an organizational position. **Vertical job specialization [20]** happens when an employee both administers the tasks, and performs them. Changes in the job specialization parameter is known as either **job enlargement [21]** or **job enrichment [22]**, depending on the dimension the job is expanded in. If an employee simply is assigned more tasks, the job is enlarged, but if the employee instead is given more control over the tasks already assigned, the job is enriched. Obviously, job enlargement seldom generates the same **motivation [23]** with the worker as job enrichment does. Jobs of complex nature, which are specialized primarily in the horizontal dimension, are referred to as **professional [24]**.

(Henry Mintzberg. The Structuring of Organizations)

**Glossary**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **1** | **Coordinating Mechanisms** | Methods used by organizations to coordinate work (e.g., mutual adjustment, supervision). |
| **2** | **Mutual Adjustment** | A simple coordination method where workers coordinate tasks among themselves. |
| **3** | **Operators** | The workers who perform the basic work of producing products or services. |
| **4** | **Basic Work** | The fundamental tasks involved in producing the organization's product or service. |
| **5** | **Division of Labor** | The separation of tasks among different people (operators or managers) to increase efficiency. |
| **6** | **Direct Supervision** | A coordination method where a manager takes responsibility for the work of others. |
| **7** | **Administrative Hierarchy** | The structure of authority built as more managers are added to supervise operators and other managers. |
| **8** | **Standardization** | A method of coordination relying on set standards for processes, outputs, or skills. |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **9** | **Analysts** | Staff members (e.g., engineers, accountants) responsible for standardizing the work of others. |
| **10** | **Work Study Analysts** | Analysts concerned with the standardization of work processes. |
| **11** | **Standardization of Work Processes** | Specifying exactly how work should be done (focus of industrial engineers). |
| **12** | **Standardization of Outputs** | Specifying the results of the work (focus of quality control and planners). |
| **13** | **Standardization of Skills** | Specifying the training required to do the work (focus of personnel trainers). |
| **14** | **Strategic Apex** | The group at the very top of the hierarchy (senior managers) and their personal staff. |
| **15** | **Operating Core** | The base of the organization consisting of the operators who do the basic work. |
| **16** | **Middle Line** | Managers who connect the strategic apex to the operating core through the chain of command. |
| **17** | **Chain of Command** | The line of authority connecting the top managers to the operators. |
| **18** | **Job Specialization** | How jobs are designed, specifically regarding the breadth and depth of tasks. |
| **19** | **Horizontal Job Specialization** | Defines the breadth (number) of tasks assigned to a position. |
| **20** | **Vertical Job Specialization** | When an employee administers (controls) the tasks as well as performs them. |
| **21** | **Job Enlargement** | Expanding a job by simply assigning more tasks (horizontal expansion). |
| **22** | **Job Enrichment** | Expanding a job by giving the employee more control over the tasks (vertical expansion). |
| **23** | **Motivation** | The drive to work; often higher in job enrichment than in job enlargement. |
| **24** | **Professional** | A complex job specialized horizontally (specialized tasks) but not vertically (worker has control). |
| **25** | **Industrial Engineers** | Analysts who focus on work processes. |
| **26** | **Quality Control Engineers** | Analysts who focus on standardizing outputs. |
| **27** | **Personnel Trainers** | Analysts responsible for standardizing skills (often happens outside the organization). |
| **28** | **Production Schedulers** | Analysts who plan and standardize the timing and output of production. |
| **29** | **Self-sufficient** | The state of operators in simple organizations who do not need supervision. |
| **30** | **Administrative Division of Labor** | The split between those who do the work and those who supervise or standardize it. |

# Digest what you read

**A. Based on the information given in the text, select True, False, or Not Given.**

.....1- Mutual adjustment is sufficient for coordinating work in a large, complex organization.
.....2- The introduction of a manager creates a division between workers and supervisors.
.....3- Analysts are part of the operating core of an organization.
.....4- Job enrichment gives employees more control over their tasks.
.....5- The strategic apex is responsible for direct supervision of operators.

**B. Select the best answer for the items below. Refer to the text to check your answers.**

1. **What is the initial coordinating mechanism in a simple organization?**
   A. Direct supervision.
   B. Standardization of outputs.
   C. Mutual adjustment.
   D. An administrative hierarchy.

2. **Who is responsible for standardization in an organization?**
   A. Operators.
   B. The strategic apex.
   C. Analysts.
   D. The middle line.

3. **What is the role of the middle line?**
   A. To standardize work processes.
   B. To produce the core product or service.
   C. To connect the strategic apex to the operating core.
   D. To design employee jobs.

4. **What is the key difference between job enlargement and job enrichment?**
   A. Job enlargement increases salary, job enrichment does not.
   B. Job enlargement adds more tasks, job enrichment gives more control.
   C. Job enlargement is for managers, job enrichment is for operators.
   D. There is no difference; they are the same.

5. **Which group typically forms the strategic apex?**
   A. The operators.
   B. The top-level managers.
   C. The analysts.
   D. The middle-line managers.

# Vocabulary Loading

**A. Using the words given in Box 1, find definitions from Box 2.**

| Box 1 | Box 2 |
|---|---|
| 1. Operators | A) The people at the lowest level who produce the basic goods or services. |
| 2. Direct Supervision | B) The process of making things uniform or consistent according to a standard. |
| 3. Standardization | C) The highest level of management in an organization. |
| 4. Strategic Apex | D) The process of dividing work into smaller, specialized tasks. |
| 5. Division of Labor | E) Coordination achieved by having one person instruct the work of others. |
| 6. Job Enrichment | F) Giving workers greater responsibility and control over their tasks. |

**B. Find matching pairs. Translate them into Arabic.**

| Part 1 | Part 2 | Pairs | Translation |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mutual | adjustment | Mutual adjustment | التعديل المتبادل |
| Administrative | hierarchy | | |
| Work | processes | | |
| Chain of | command | | |
| Operating | core | | |
| Job | specialization | | |
| Horizontal | dimension | | |
| Quality | control | | |
| Administrative | labor | | |
| Personal | staff | | |

**C. Fill in the blanks using the proper words from the previous section.**

1. In a factory, the workers on the assembly line are the _____.
2. The CEO and the board of directors form the _____ of the company.
3. _____ involves giving an employee more autonomy over their work.
4. The _____ refers to the formal line of authority from top to bottom.
5. Introducing _____ allows an organization to ensure consistent quality in its products.

**D. Enhancing Your Vocabulary**

**Match the words on the left with their synonyms on the right.**

1. Elaborate | a) Complex
2. Core | b) Central
3. Emerge | c) Appear
4. Coordinate | d) Organize
5. Crucial | e) Vital

## Grammar Injection

**Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verbs from the reading.**

*Rely, Introduce, Form, Turn, Standardize, Connect, Define, Assign, Generate, Refer*

1. Simple organizations _____ on mutual adjustment for coordination.
2. Growth _____ the need for direct supervision.
3. Top managers _____ the strategic apex.
4. As organizations grow, they _____ to standardization.
5. Analysts _____ work processes and outputs.
6. The middle line _____ the strategic apex to the operating core.
7. Horizontal specialization _____ the breadth of tasks.
8. Managers _____ tasks to employees.
9. Job enrichment _____ more motivation than job enlargement.
10. We _____ to complex jobs as professional.

**Grammar Handling**

**Relative Clauses**

Relative clauses are used to give more information about a noun without starting a new sentence. They are introduced by relative pronouns like **who**, **which**, **that**, and **whose**.

**Uses of Relative Pronouns:**

- **Who:** refers to people (the subject).
    - *The manager **who** hired me is very supportive.*
- **Which/That:** refers to things or concepts.
    - *The strategy **that** we implemented was successful.*
    - *Standardization, **which** is a key coordinating mechanism, improves efficiency.*
- **Whose:** shows possession for people or things.

- *The analyst **whose** report we read is an expert.*

- **Whom:** refers to people (the object of the verb). *More formal.*
  - *The operator **whom** the manager supervised was new.* (Often replaced by 'who' in spoken English)

**Defining vs. Non-Defining Clauses:**

- **Defining Clause:** Essential to the meaning of the sentence. No commas.
  - *The operators **who work in the core** are essential.* (Specifies which operators)
- **Non-Defining Clause:** Gives extra, non-essential information. Uses commas.
  - *The strategic apex, **which includes the CEO,** sets the overall direction.* (Adds extra info about the apex)

**Practice:**

**Combine the sentences using a relative pronoun (who, which, that, whose).**

1. The organization is large. It uses standardization.
2. The analysts are important. They design work processes.
3. The manager is on leave. His team is very efficient.
4. Job enrichment is a method. It increases employee motivation.

## Translate the text into Arabic.

As the organization grows and adopts a more complex division of labor among its operators, the need is increasingly felt for direct supervision. So, whereas the division of labor up to this point has been between the operators themselves, the introduction of a manager introduces a first administrative division of labor in the structure - between those who do the work and those who supervise it.

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.....
.....

## Self-check: Check your progress in this unit. Tick (√) the statements which are true about you.

• I can identify and describe the five basic parts of an organization.
• I understand the concepts of job enlargement and job enrichment.
• I have learned more than 20 new words from this unit.
• I can use relative clauses to add information to a sentence.
• This unit helped me understand my technical subject better.